The Bombay Salesian Society's
DON BOSCO INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
An Autonomous Institute Affiliated to University of Mumbai
Premier Automobiles Road, Kurla West, Mumbai - 400070

Report on - Building Small Language Models (SLMs)

Title: Building Small Language Models (SLMs)
Date: 24th February, 2026
Time: 06 PM to 07 PM (IST)
Venue: Online

Target Audience: Open for All

No. of Participants Present: 21

No. of Girl Participants Present: 7

No. of Boy Participants Present: 13

Resource Person: Lucky Rathore
Organization of Recourse Person: Founder, SciFi
Organizing Department / Committee / Authority: IEEE – CS
Faculty Coordinator: Mr. Tayyabali Sayyad

Objectives:
❖To introduce participants to the concept and applications of Small Language Models (SLMs).
❖To explain the key differences between SLMs and LLMs.
❖To provide hands-on experience in fine-tuning pre-trained SLMs using Hugging Face.
❖To demonstrate dataset preparation, training, evaluation, and deployment of SLMs.
❖To guide participants in building a complete end-to-end SLM project.

Outcomes:
❖Participants gained practical understanding of SLM architecture and working.
❖Participants successfully prepared datasets and fine-tuned a small language model.
❖Participants learned to evaluate model performance and test outputs.
❖Participants understood basic deployment options for real-world use.
❖ Participants received resources and project ideas for further learning

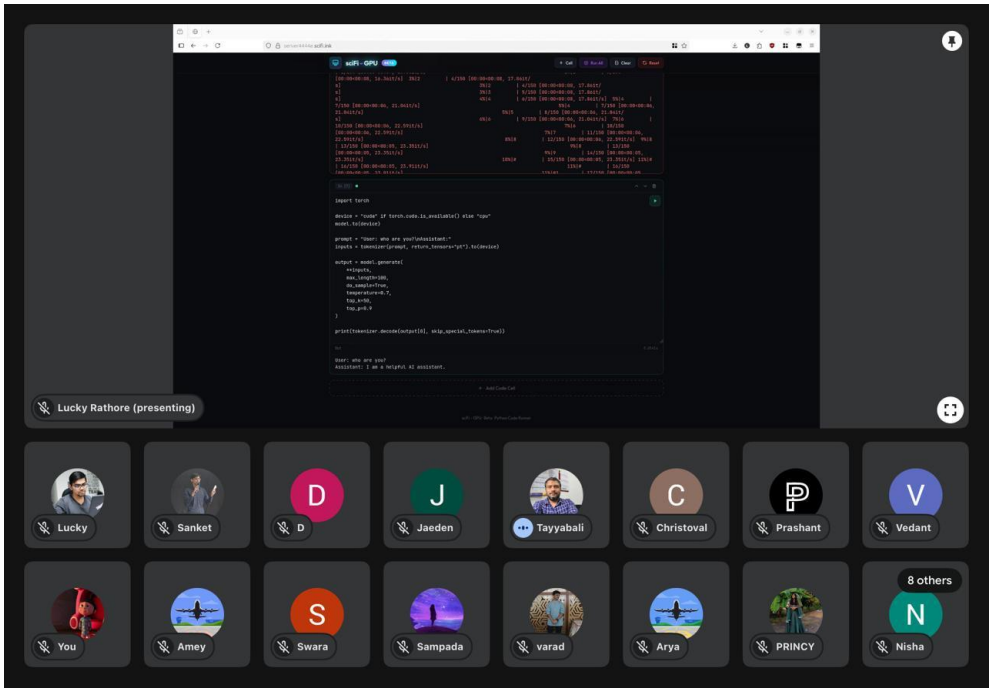
Detailed Report:

The IEEE DBIT CS hosted a workshop on Small Language Models (SLMs) on 24 February 2026. The session was led by the resource person - Mr. Lucky Rathore, founder of Sci-fi. It was coordinated by Smruti and Jaeden (Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson, IEEE DBIT - CS) and attended by 21 participants.

The workshop introduced the fundamentals and applications of SLMs, highlighted their distinctions from Large Language Models (LLMs), and demonstrated fine-tuning techniques using Hugging Face. It also explained dataset preparation, training, evaluation, and deployment, giving attendees a comprehensive overview of the end-to-end workflow involved in building an SLM project.

The workshop proved highly beneficial, enabling participants to develop a practical understanding of SLM architecture and its working principles. They learned how datasets are structured, how models can be fine-tuned, and how performance is assessed through testing outputs. The session also covered basic deployment strategies and provided resources and project ideas to encourage continued exploration. Overall, the event enriched participants' technical knowledge, sparked interest in scalable AI solutions, and reinforced IEEE DBIT's commitment to fostering impactful educational initiatives.

Snapshot of the Event:



Feedback Analysis:

The participant feedback indicates that the session was well-received overall, with 83.3% of respondents rating it 7 or higher on a 10-point scale.

The most common rating was 7 (41.7%), suggesting that while participants found the session valuable, they also identified scope for further improvement. Only two respondents rated the session below 7.

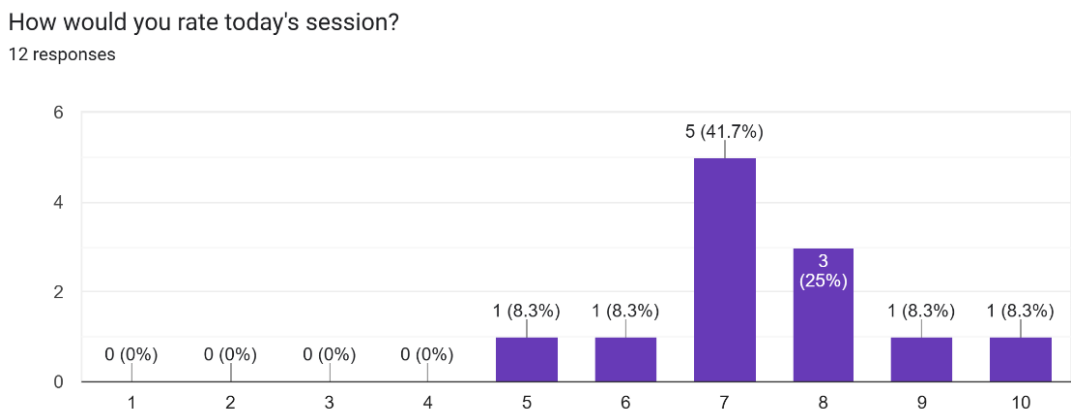
In terms of demographics, the majority of attendees were from the Electronics and Telecommunication (EXTC) branch (58.3%), followed by Computer Science (33.3%) and Information Technology (8.3%).

The gender distribution was 75% male and 25% female.

Qualitative feedback provided additional insights.

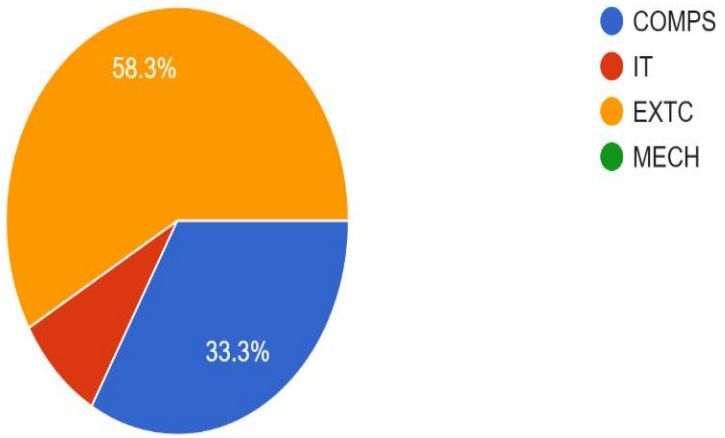
One participant suggested that the session could be made *"more simple and interactive"*, pointing to the need for accessible explanations and greater engagement through interactive elements.

Another participant stated, they would *"like to attend more sessions on such trending topics."* This highlights both the perceived relevance of the session and the demand for future events focused on emerging technologies.



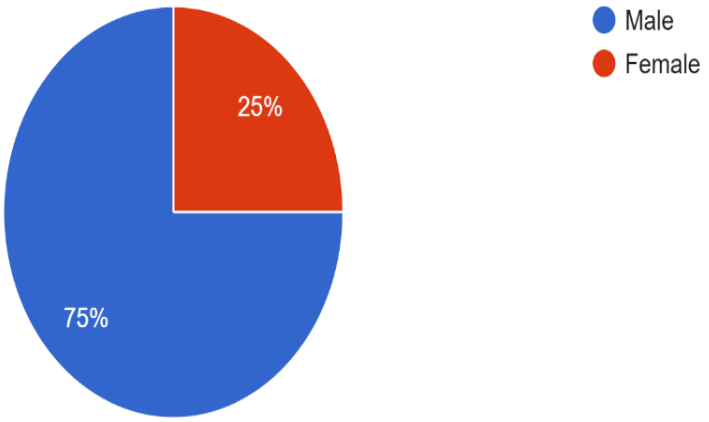
Branch

12 responses



Gender

12 responses



Event Poster:

Registration Details:

No. of Students Registered: 48
Girls: 19
Boys: 29

Details of the Attendees:

No of IEEE DBIT Members:
No of Non IEEE DBIT Members:

No of Students Attended: 21

S. No.	Name	Branch
1	Aarya Rashinker	EXTC
2	Amey Kanade	EXTC
3	Arya Dharmadhikari	IT
4	Chetan Chaudhari	IT
5	Christoval Dsouza	EXTC
6	D Shetty	IT
7	Harshit Patil	EXTC
8	Hrishikesh Gunjal	EXTC
9	Kevin	COMPS
10	Nisha Cardin	COMPS
11	Prashant Dhond	COMPS
12	Princy D'Souza	COMPS
13	Sanket Jadhav	COMPS
14	Rohit Kumar	EXTC
15	Shariya Ansari	IT
16	Swara Ghosalkar	EXTC
17	Vedant Apraj	COMPS
18	Shreya Manoj	EXTC
19	Sampada Kaginkar	IT
20	Aarya Jadhav	EXTC
21	Varad Khadilkar	COMPS

Report Prepared By: IEEE-DBIT

Name of the Student: Aarya Jadhav & Shreya Manoj

Post of the student:
Reporting Head & Joint Reporting Head, IEEE-DBIT

Report Approved By: Ms. Freda Carvalho

Name of the Faculty: Ms. Freda Carvalho

Post of the Faculty: